# Can for ability

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

## Qué vas a aprender

- Say what you can and can't do
- Use can with all persons, always the same
- Ask «Can you...?» and answer «Yes, I can / No, I can't»
- Talk about the abilities of animals and robots

## Para pensar

**Un pájaro vuela, pero no sabe leer. Tú sabes leer, pero no vuelas. ¿Qué palabra mágica del inglés sirve para decir lo que cada uno sabe hacer?**

## Explicación

### I can!

We use *can* to talk about **abilities**: things we are able to do. «I **can** run.» «I **can** sing.» «I **can** count to one hundred.» After *can*, we put the verb: **can + run**, **can + swim**.

**En castellano:** *can* significa «saber» o «poder»: «I can swim» = «sé nadar». Es uno de los verbos más útiles del inglés. Di en voz alta tres cosas que *can* hacer: «I can… I can… I can…!»




### Action verbs

We need *action verbs* to talk about abilities: **run** (correr), **jump** (saltar), **swim** (nadar), **fly** (volar), **climb** (trepar), **dance** (bailar), **sing** (cantar), **skip** (saltar a la comba), **ride a bike** (montar en bici), **play the piano**, **draw** (dibujar) and **cook** (cocinar).

Play **Action mime**: one child mimes a verb and the class guesses: «You can swim!». Moverte te ayuda a recordar las palabras.



## Can is the same for everybody

*Can* is very easy: it **never changes**. I can, you can, **he can**, **she can**, **it can**, we can, they can. We never add -s: «She **can** dance», not «she cans dance».

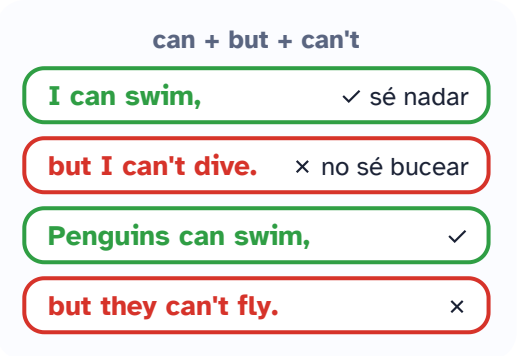
And the verb after *can* doesn't change either: «He can **swim**», not «he can swims» or «he can to swim». **Truco:** piensa que *can* es como un ayudante que siempre va igual vestido, con cualquier persona.

| person | can + verb |
|---|---|
| I / you | can swim |
| he / she | can swim |
| it | can swim |
| we / they | can swim |

## I can't

To say that we are **not** able to do something, we use can't (**cannot**): «I **can't** fly.» «My baby brother **can't** walk.» «Fish **can't** climb trees.»

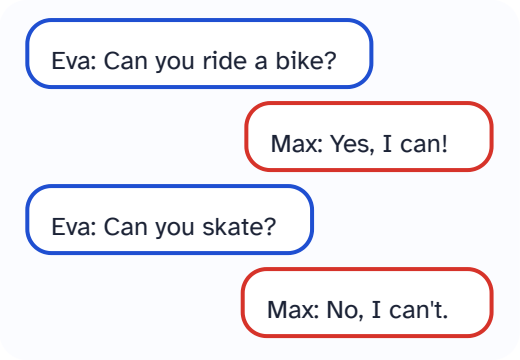
We can join two sentences with but (pero): «I can swim, **but** I can't dive.» «Penguins can swim, **but** they can't fly.» **Pronunciación:** escucha bien la **t** final: *can* (sí) y *can't* (no) suenan parecido.




## Can you...?

To ask about abilities, put Can first: «**Can you** ride a bike?», «**Can your dog** jump?», «**Can they** speak English?».

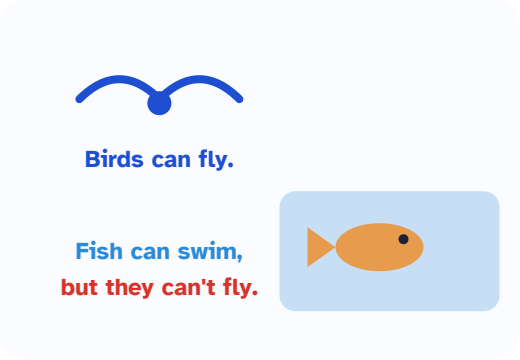
The short answers are: **Yes, I can.** / **No, I can't.**; **Yes, it can.** / **No, it can't. En castellano:** «¿Sabes montar en bici?» → «Can you ride a bike?». Solo cambias el orden: *can* va delante de la persona.




## Animals can...

Animals have got amazing abilities. «Birds **can** fly.» «Fish **can** swim.» «Monkeys **can** climb trees.» «Kangaroos **can** jump very high.» «Parrots **can** talk.» «Cheetahs **can** run very fast.»

But they can't do everything: «Elephants **can't** jump.» «Snakes **can't** walk.» «Penguins **can't** fly.» **Reto:** piensa en tu animal favorito y di una cosa que *can* y otra que *can't* hacer.

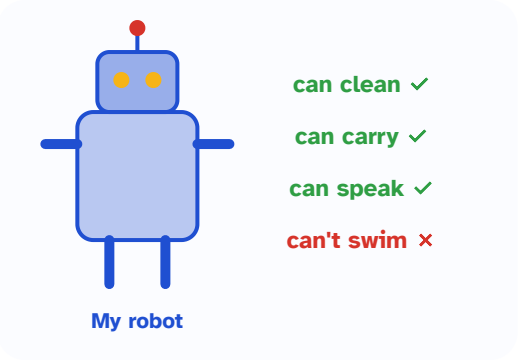



## Robots and superheroes

Let's imagine! A **robot** can do many things: «My robot **can** clean my room. It **can** carry heavy boxes. It **can** speak ten languages. But it **can't** swim: water is dangerous for robots!»

And a **superhero**? «Super Lola **can** fly and she **can** run faster than a car. She **can** see through walls. She **can't** cook!» Inventa tu propio robot o superhéroe y di tres

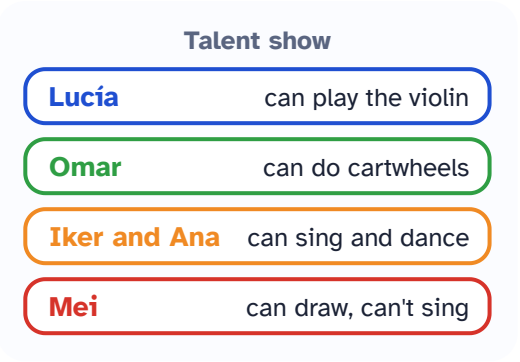
cosas que *can* y una que *can't*.




## Reading: the school talent show

Read the poster: «**Talent Show** on Friday! Come and see the stars of class 3A. **Lucía** can play the violin. **Omar** can do ten cartwheels (volteretas laterales). **Iker and Ana** can sing and dance. **Mei** can't sing, but she can draw a portrait in one minute! And our headteacher can juggle with three balls!»

Answer: What can Omar do? Can Mei sing? Who can play the violin?




## Let's practise: Find someone who can…

Play **Find someone who can…** Your card says: whistle (silbar), touch your toes, count to 20 in English, stand on one foot, say the alphabet. Walk around and ask: «**Can you whistle?**» If the answer is «**Yes, I can**», they show you and you write their name.

At the end, tell the class: «Pablo can whistle. Sara can stand on one foot. Nobody can say the alphabet backwards!» ¡Gana quien complete la tarjeta antes!

**Find someone who can...**

- **whistle** — Pablo
- **touch your toes** — Sara
- **count to 20** —
- **stand on one foot** —

## Can for ability

sí sé

**CAN**

I can swim.
She can sing.

no sé

**CAN'T**

I can't fly.
= cannot

pregunta

**CAN YOU...?**

Can you skate?
Yes, I can.

unir

**BUT**

I can run,
but I can't fly.

## Ejercicios

1. **Traduce: correr, saltar, trepar, volar.**

2. **Completa: «Birds ___ fly.»**

3. **Completa: «Fish ___ walk.» (no)**

4. **Pregunta: «your sister / sing».**

5. **Respuesta corta (sí): «Can you dance?»**

6. **Respuesta corta (no): «Can it fly?»**

7. **Une con but: «I can draw.» «I can't paint.»**

8. **Corrige: «He can plays tennis.»**

9. **Escribe una cosa que un pingüino can y otra que can't.**

10. **Escribe tres cosas que sabes hacer.**

## Practica

1. **«Sé nadar» is...**

   **A)** I swim can.

   **B)** I can swim.

   **C)** I cans swim.

2. **Birds ___ fly.**

   **A)** can

   **B)** cans

   **C)** can to

3. **Elephants ___ jump.**

   **A)** can

   **B)** cans

   **C)** can't

4. **She can ___.**

   **A)** dances

   **B)** to dance

   **C)** dance

5. **«Can you skate?» — «Yes, ...»**

   **A)** I can.

   **B)** I do.

   **C)** I am.

6. **«Can it swim?» — «No, ...»**

   **A)** it isn't.

   **B)** it can't.

   **C)** it don't.

7. **«Trepar» is...**

   **A)** climb

   **B)** jump

   **C)** fly

8. **___ you ride a bike?**

   **A)** Do

**B)** Are

**C)** Can

9. **I can sing, ___ I can't dance.**

**A)** and

**B)** but

**C)** or

10. **«Cannot» is the same as...**

**A)** can

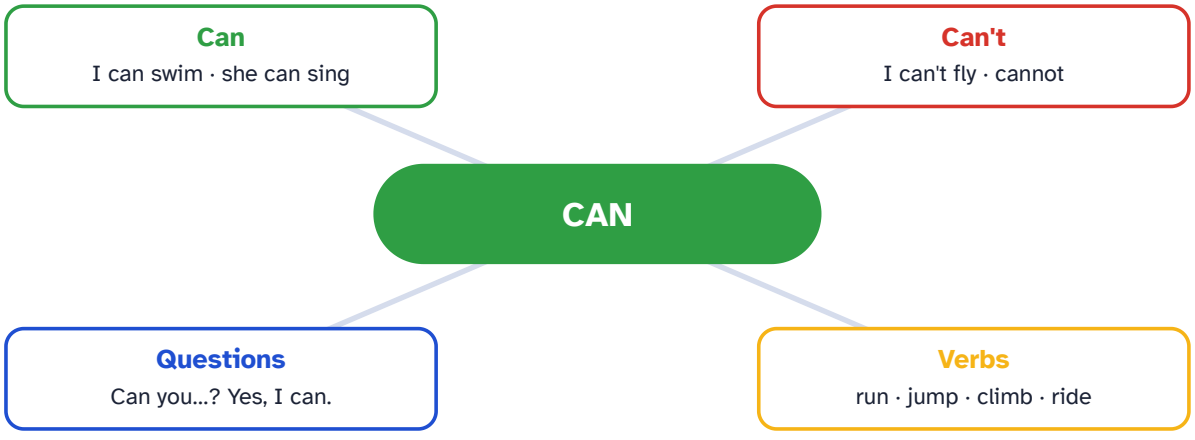
**B)** can't

**C)** can not to

## Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Para qué sirve can; Por qué can no cambia con ninguna persona; Cómo se dice lo que no sé hacer y cómo uno frases con but; Cómo pregunto Can you...? y respondo.

## Resumen



## Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

**can**

Saber / poder hacer algo.

**can't (cannot)**

No saber / no poder.

**Can you…?**

¿Sabes…? ¿Puedes…?

**Yes, I can. / No, I can't.**

Respuestas cortas.

**can + verbo**

Sin -s y sin to: she can swim.

**but**

Pero: I can run, but I can't fly.

**climb**

Trepar.

**ride a bike**

Montar en bici.

## Soluciones

1. **B)** Can + verbo.
2. **A)** Can.
3. **C)** No pueden.
4. **C)** Verbo sin -s.
5. **A)** Yes, I can.
6. **B)** It can't.
7. **A)** Climb.
8. **C)** Can delante.
9. **B)** Contraste: but.
10. **B)** Can't.

## Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. run, jump, climb, fly.
2. can.
3. can't.
4. Can your sister sing?
5. Yes, I can.
6. No, it can't.
7. I can draw, but I can't paint.
8. He can play tennis.
9. Penguins can swim, but they can't fly.
10. Model answer: I can ride a bike. I can swim. I can play the guitar.